The Cobbler Project

How to use the app: a guide to every page

The Cobbler Project is an all-in-one workspace for journalists, filmmakers, artists, writers and musicians: planning, research, interviews, scripting, editing and publishing, all in one place. Everything runs in your web browser and is saved on your own computer.

Your first week

The pages are listed below in the order the sidebar shows them, but a project doesn't unfold alphabetically. Here's the order most do, and which page to be on at each point. (Or take the **guided tour** from Home or Settings › Tutorial: it points at everything on every page in about ten minutes.)

1. **Day 1: set up.** Sign in with your name (the person button, bottom right). Make a project with the + button and give it a line of description. On **Settings**, turn on automatic backups to a folder, or at least note where "Back up all projects" is. Pick a theme if you like.
2. **Day 1: the idea.** Put the raw thought on **Ideas**, however rough. The lightbulb button keeps the ideas beside you on every other page, so jot as you go. When one firms up, "Pitch it →" moves it to **Pitches**.
3. **Day 2: people and dates.** Add the crew or collaborators on **Team**, with roles and contacts. On **Project Tracker**, fill in the type, status, started and target dates and the drive links; these dates, and everything else with a date, appear on the **Calendar**.
4. **Day 2: research.** One note per claim, figure or lead on **Research**, each with its sources and a status. Later, the Writing page's Check tab will warn you when a draft leans on something still unverified.
5. **Day 3: the people in it.** On **Interviews**, add who you'll talk to, move them through the stages, pick their questions from the bank and print the question sheet. Shoot dates export to your calendar; release forms are tracked per person.
6. **Day 3: the plan.** Write the script on **Screenplay** (or the draft on **Writing**), draw key shots on **Storyboarder**, then open **Shot List** and add shots from the screenplay's scenes and the storyboard's frames. Give each list a date, call time and location, and export the call sheet for the crew.
7. **Day 4: shoot.** On set, open the shot list on your phone and tick shots off; the Board view shows each shot with its storyboard frame. Afterwards, drop recordings' transcripts into **Media & Transcripts**.
8. **Day 5: the cut.** In Media & Transcripts › Text Edit, build the paper edit from transcript paragraphs, then Export Timeline for Resolve or Premiere. **A/V Script** turns the paper edit into a two-column script for the edit or the client.

9. **Day 6: out the door. Packaging** holds titles, thumbnails, descriptions and tags per platform, with deliverables to tick off. Writers: Writing › Business tracks submissions and invoices. Musicians: **Music** has the song sketchbook, split sheets, gigs and releases.
10. **Any day: work with others.** On **Projects**, share the project as a file, or set up a sync folder in Google Drive so everyone's changes merge automatically. Comments (the speech bubble) can be assigned to people and show up in their tasks. The search box in the sidebar finds anything in the project, and Cmd/Ctrl+Z undoes your last change on any page.

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1. Getting started

Opening the app. If it's online (for example on GitHub Pages), just open its address. Your projects still stay on your own computer: the website only sends the app, never your work. Otherwise open `pages/index.html` in Chrome, Firefox, Safari or Edge. Double-clicking the file works for almost everything. A few features that store files (uploads, datasets, photos behind storyboard frames) and downloading the app as a ZIP work best when the app is opened from a local server; the code guide explains how (it's one command).

Getting around. The ≡ button (top left) opens and closes the sidebar, which lists every page. On a computer the sidebar stays open beside the page; on a phone or tablet it slides over the page.

Search this project. The box in the sidebar (Ctrl+K or ⌘K jumps to it) looks through everything in the active project: notes, ideas, tasks, people, questions, pitches, packages, transcripts, paper edits, storyboards, zines, drafts, scripts, songs, shot lists, resources and comments. Results are grouped by page; click one to go there (lists, storyboards and zines open straight to the item). Transcripts kept outside the project are searched by title only.

Exporting as PDF or Word. Most pages have a pair of **PDF** and **Word** buttons near the top (Ideas, Research, Pitches, Packaging, Interviews, Team, Resources, Data Analysis, Shot List, Calendar, Writing, Screenplay, Storyboarder, Projects). PDF opens the print window, where you

choose “Save as PDF”; Word downloads a .docx that opens in Word, Pages or Google Docs. Each export is what's on screen at the time (the open package, the filtered notes, the current dataset).

Which browser. The app works best in Chrome or Edge on a computer. Safari and Firefox do nearly everything, but can't sync through a folder or back up to a folder automatically (use Share, Import and the backup download instead), and need recent versions to read Excel files. Settings › This browser lists what yours can do. On a phone or tablet everything works, with the pages laid out for the narrower screen; the shot list becomes a stack of cards.

The round buttons at the bottom right are on every page:

- **Lightbulb** (top of the four): opens your project's ideas in a panel on the right, on any page (see Ideas). It stays open from page to page until you close it.
- **Person**: sign in with your name, change it, or sign out. It shows your initial while you're signed in.
- + starts a new project.
- **Speech bubble** opens comments for the page you're on (see Comments). Its number shows how many comments are still open.

Every page also has a **Return to top** button at the bottom.

Offline and installing. Once you've opened the app online, your browser keeps a copy, so it opens without a connection too (your projects are on your computer anyway). Chrome and Edge also offer to **install** it (the icon in the address bar, or the browser menu › Install), which gives it a window and an icon of its own. When a new version is published, a note offers to reload.

Undo and redo. Cmd+Z (Ctrl+Z on Windows) undoes your last change on any page: a deleted card, a ticked box, a moved scene, an edited field. Cmd+Shift+Z (or Ctrl+Y) redoes it. While you're typing in a box, Cmd+Z undoes your typing there, as usual; click outside the box to undo whole changes. The page redraws itself to show the change (no reload), and a note at the bottom offers Redo. Undo remembers your last 60 changes in that browser tab. It won't undo changes that arrived from collaborators.

Signing in. Click the person button (bottom right) and type your name. It goes on your changes, comments, tasks and synced files, so the people you work with know who did what, and it's how “My tasks” and the Home page know what's yours. There's no password and no account: the name is kept in this browser only. The same button changes your name or signs you out (your work stays; new changes are marked “Someone” until you sign in again). The first time you open the app it asks once; if you click “Not now”, the button is always there.

Home shows what's due in the next week (and what's overdue), what's assigned to you, what's in progress in the active project, and recent activity, plus a link to this tutorial.

2. Projects

A **project** holds everything you make: its tracker details, team, research, interviews, pitches, ideas, edits, storyboards, zines, datasets, resources and comments. Each page shows the **active project**,

named on the Projects button in the sidebar.

The Projects button (sidebar)

Switching projects, making a new one or restoring a backup redraws the page you're on with that project's work; nothing reloads.

- Switch between projects, rename or delete the current one.
- **+ New project**.
- **Backup**: download this project or all projects as a .json file, or **Restore** one. Restoring always adds new projects; it never overwrites.

The Projects page

- Cards for every project, with search and sorting.
- **Make active**, **Archive / Unarchive**, Rename, Duplicate, Delete.
- **Share**: a *full copy* for collaborators (everything, uploaded images and drawings included, which they can edit and send back to merge), the same *by email*, or a *read-only copy for feedback*: editors and beta readers can read it and add comments, then click **Send my comments back**; when you import that file, only their comments come into your project.
- **Lock a version**: keeps the project exactly as it is now (“Picture lock”, “Final draft”), in this browser, where syncing and merging never change it. **Locked versions** opens one as a new project or downloads it.
- **Export**: a backup file (.json) you can import later.
- **Details (.docx)** and **Details (PDF)**: everything in the project as a readable document (tracker details and goals, team, tasks, research, interviews, pitches, packaging, writing, sources, records requests, timeline, submissions, songs, gigs, releases, samples, ideas, events, edits, storyboards, zines, media, datasets, resources and comments).
- **Import Projects**: choose or drop backup or shared files, preview them and pick what to do with each: add it as a new project, or **merge** it into a project you have.

Working on a project with friends

1. One person clicks **Share** on the project and sends the file (email, Dropbox, a USB stick).
2. Everyone else imports it: it's added as a new project.
3. Work separately. When someone sends their copy back, import it: it's matched to your copy and *Merge into “…” (your copy)* is picked for you.
4. Before merging you see what it brings in and any **differences** (the same thing changed differently on both sides): choose *Keep yours* or *Use theirs* for each.

- **Email** on a project card attaches the shared file to a new email (where your browser can attach it; otherwise it downloads the file and opens an email to your team for you to attach it to), with a list of what changed.
- **Changes since last share** lists what you (and anyone you merged) added, changed and deleted since you last shared: copy it into a message or download it.

- **Undo last merge** appears on a card after a merge and puts the project back as it was.
- If you've shared a project before and it has changed since, a **reminder** appears after 5 days (change the number of days, or turn it off, in the Sync folder section).

Comments, research, interviews, edits, tasks and the rest are combined, matched item by item. Your browser remembers the last version you sent or received, so changes only one of you made are taken without asking, and things the other person deleted are removed. The very first merge doesn't have that to go on, so anything deleted on one side comes back from the other. **Back up mine first** downloads your copy before merging.

Syncing through a shared folder (Google Drive)

Instead of sending files back and forth, everyone can point the app at the same shared folder, and the projects you choose stay up to date by themselves. The projects stay in your browser and in that folder only.

1. Install **Google Drive for desktop** and sign in. One person makes a folder in Google Drive and shares it with everyone as an editor; everyone else adds a shortcut to it in My Drive (Shared with me › right-click › Organize › Add shortcut).
2. Sign in with your name (the person button). On the Projects page, under **Sync folder**, click **Choose sync folder** and pick that folder. Allow the app to edit files there.
3. Tick **Sync** on the projects to share. Collaborators see them under *Projects in the folder* and click **Join**.

From then on the app checks the folder every 30 seconds while it's open, and soon after you change something. Each person writes only their own file in the folder, so Google Drive never has to sort out two people saving the same file. When someone's changes arrive on the page you're looking at, a note offers to show them (your own changes are kept). Changes you save in another tab of the same browser show up on their own. The sidebar shows when it last synced; if your browser asks for permission again, click that note. Folder sync needs Chrome or Edge on a computer; Dropbox, iCloud Drive or any synced folder works the same way.

Differences settled automatically

When syncing finds that you and a collaborator both changed the same thing, it keeps the newer change, and lists it under **Differences settled automatically** on the Projects page: what was kept, what the other version was. **Use … instead** switches to the other version (and that syncs too); **That's right** clears it from the list.

Activity and claims

Activity (Projects page) lists who added, changed or deleted what in the active project, newest first; filter by person. Every change is stamped with your name (sign in with the person button).

Claim (on drafts, songs, paper edits and packages) tells collaborators you're working on something, so two people don't rework the same thing. Click *Done* when you've finished, or *Take over* if someone forgot.

Archiving hides a finished project from the Project Tracker, the sidebar's project menu and the Projects page (tick *Show archived* to see it). The project you're working in can't be archived; making an archived project active brings it back.

3. Project Tracker

One row for every project. Click a cell to change it. Columns: Project Name (renames the project), Medium, Status, In Progress, Next Up, Goals, Link to Pitch Doc, Team Members, Target Completion, Taxonomy, Began On, Target Publication, Finished On, Published On, Link to Final Product and Notes.

- **Dates** can be typed any way you like: `12 Oct 2026`, `Oct 12`, `2026-10-12`, `12/10/26`, `today`, `tomorrow`. Or use the calendar button. Target dates turn red when they've passed and the work isn't finished.
- **Goals**: click the Goals cell to open goal cards under the project: name, sub-tasks with tick boxes, people involved, status and barriers. In lists, Enter adds a line and Backspace on an empty line removes it. *Remove goal* deletes a card.
- **Team Members** shows the people on the project's Team page. *Edit team* → opens that page.
- Search, filter by status, sort by any column, **Export CSV**, **+ Add project**, and *Show archived*.

4. Team

Each project has its own team. Choose the project under *Team for*, then **+ Add person**: name, pronouns, roles (pick several, or type your own), email, phone, preferred contact, other contact, location or time zone, and notes.

- Filter by role, search and sort.
- **Copy emails** (ready for an email's To: line), **Download contacts (.vcf)** for Contacts/Outlook/Google, or **Export CSV**.

Tasks

Jobs for people on the team, with due dates (they appear on the Calendar). **Everyone** groups tasks by person; **My tasks** shows yours (choose your name under *I am*), in this project or in *All projects*. Enter in a task adds another. Comments assigned to someone appear with their tasks: assign one from the Comments panel on any page.

Credits

Credits builds end credits from the team's roles, plus “Featuring” the people you filmed (from Interviews, at Filmed or later). Edit the text freely: a line ending in “:” is a role, the lines under it are names. Choose the layout, font, colours and size, then:

- **Copy text** to paste into a Text+ title or Effects › Titles › Scroll in DaVinci Resolve.

- **Cards (.png)**: one image per screenful (a ZIP when there are several). Transparent by default, to lay over the picture on a track above it.
- **Scrolling roll (.png)**: one tall image that starts and ends with an empty screen. Put it on a track and keyframe Inspector › Transform › Position Y from bottom to top.

5. Ideas

A three-column board for drafting notes and ideas. Rename the columns by clicking their names. **+ Add idea** and type; empty cards disappear when you click away. Move cards by dragging ⠿ or with ← →. **Pitch it** → turns an idea into a draft on the Pitches page.

Ideas on every page. The lightbulb button (bottom right, above the person button) opens the same cards in a panel on the right, on any page: jot a new idea, edit one, move it along with ← →, or drop it. The panel stays open from page to page until you close it.

6. Pitches

Each pitch has a working title, the hook, the story, why now, why me/access, format, length, audience, supporting links and notes, plus a status (Idea → Drafting → Ready to send → Pitched → Commissioned or Passed).

- Under **Outlets**, add each outlet and editor with the date sent and their reply. **Copy email** writes the pitch as an email to that editor; **Open in mail app** starts it in your email.
- **Download (.md)** saves the pitch as a document.
- **Package it** (on a pitch's card) starts packages on the Packaging page for the video, the article and the zine listing at once.

7. Packaging

Titles, thumbnails and SEO for everywhere your work will appear. Make one **package** per place: a YouTube video, Shorts/Reels/TikTok, an Instagram post, an article, a newsletter, a zine shop listing, a podcast episode or something else. Each platform shows only the fields it uses, with live character counts against its limits (amber past what shows in full, red past the hard limit).

- **+ New package**: pick one or more places it's going, and optionally a pitch to start from. Several made together (or from one pitch) are **one story**: their keywords and audience stay the same as you edit any of them (*Unlink* to stop).
- **The basics**: the primary keyword people would search for, other keywords (suggested from the Project Tracker's taxonomy) and who it's for.
- **Titles**: brainstorm as many as you like (Enter adds another), or **Try a formula…**. ★ the one to use.
- **Thumbnail concepts**: the text on the thumbnail (5 words or fewer reads best), notes on the image, and an optional mock-up image. The preview shows it at feed and phone size, with the

running time of your first paper edit.

- **Description**: shows what appears before "more". **Add chapters from…** turns a paper edit's sections, or markers imported from Resolve (all, or one colour), into YouTube chapters; **+ Credits from your team** lists the Team page's roles.
- **Tags and hashtags**: type and press Enter or comma; paste a comma-separated list to add several.
- **Alt text** for each image, and for web pages and listings, **Search and sharing**: SEO title, meta description, URL slug and social share text, with a search-result preview.
- **Deliverables**: what to render and hand over for the platform (master render, loudness, captions, thumbnail, vertical version, project archive…), each with where to find the setting in DaVinci Resolve. Tick them off, add your own, or copy the list.
- The **Checklist** ticks things off as you go. **Copy** buttons copy each field for pasting into YouTube Studio or elsewhere; **Download (.txt)** saves the lot.

8. Research

Notes for claims, figures and leads. Each note has a status (**? Unverified**, **✓ Verified** or ⚠ **Disputed**), the exact quote or figure to check, as many sources as you need (links are clickable), notes and tags. Filter by status or tag, search, and change a note's status straight from its card.

9. Interviews

People

A board of people by stage: Researching, Reached out, Pre-interview, Scheduled, Filmed, Follow Up Requested and Follow Up Complete. Drag cards by ⠿ or use ← →. Click a name to open their details: who they are, contact, shoot date, time and location, release form status, a logistics checklist and the questions for their interview.

Questions as PDF (in a person's window) prints the questions you've ticked for them: titled with their name, with a tick box per question, double spaced so a printed copy has room for notes.

Shoot schedule

Upcoming, not yet scheduled and past shoots. **Download calendar (.ics)** adds them to your calendar app.

Question bank

Questions grouped by topic. Add your own, or **Add starter questions** for a general set to edit.

10. Calendar

Every date entered in the project, in one place: Project Tracker milestones, interview shoots and release forms, pitches sent, tasks due, writing deadlines, embargoes and records-request deadlines, gigs and release-plan steps, and your own events (**+ Add event**). Switch between a list and a month grid, filter by where dates come from, or show all projects. Click a date's source to change it where it was entered.

Download calendar (.ics) for Apple Calendar, Google Calendar or Outlook, or **Save list as PDF**.

Shared calendar… makes one calendar file for everyone you work with: pick the projects, the kinds of dates and whose tasks. It always has the same name, so keep it in a shared folder (Dropbox, Google Drive) and replace it when dates change. Everyone subscribes to its link once (Apple Calendar: File › New Calendar Subscription; Google Calendar: Other calendars › From URL; Outlook: Subscribe from web) and their calendars update by themselves. The dialog has step-by-step help.

11. Media & Transcripts

Media & Transcripts tab

- **Import transcripts** (.srt, .vtt or .txt from DaVinci Resolve, Descript, Otter, Rev, Premiere, YouTube…) or **Paste a transcript**.
- **From DaVinci Resolve**: transcribe the clip, put it on a timeline, use Create Subtitles from Audio, then File › Export › Subtitle… (.srt). Resolve's subtitles start at the timeline's 01:00:00:00, so times an hour or more in are moved back to 00:00 automatically. Speaker labels like [Speaker 1] become speakers you can rename. **Shift times** on a transcript moves every time by an amount you choose.
- **Import Resolve markers**: notes made in Resolve, brought in. In Resolve, right-click the timeline in the Media Pool › Timelines › Export › Timeline Markers to EDL… (or export a CSV from the Edit Index). They're listed with their colour, name and note; **Add all as comments** (or one colour) puts them in this page's Comments to reply to, assign and resolve, and the Packaging page can turn them into YouTube chapters.
- **Import clips from a timeline**: an FCPXML from Final Cut Pro or DaVinci Resolve, or an XML from Premiere Pro. Transcripts link to clips with the same name, so timecodes line up with your footage.
- Rename speakers, pick a transcript's clip by hand, set the project's frame rate, and **search every transcript**.
- **Where transcripts are kept**: transcripts are the biggest thing in a project. Each one says where its words are *Stored in*, and **Keep it** moves it:
  - **Inside the project** (the usual): shared and synced with the project, so long transcripts make sharing slower.
  - **This browser's file storage**: plenty of room. Shares and the sync folder still carry it to collaborators.

    - **A folder**, e.g. a shared Google Drive folder (*Choose a folder…*, or your sync folder): saved as *Cobbler transcripts › project › title [id].json*, with a copy in this browser so it opens straight away. If that copy is cleared, the app reads it from the folder.

  Every move is logged with when, who and where: open *Where it's been* on the transcript. **Move all** (above the list) moves every transcript at once. The project report lists where each transcript is kept.
- **Where everyone keeps the media**: each person's footage and proxy folders and notes (drive, computer). Pick a person under *Clip paths for* when exporting a timeline and it points at their copy of the footage, so Resolve finds the clips without relinking.

Text Edit tab (paper edit)

- The transcript sits beside your edit. **Select words** and choose *Add soundbite*; **click a timecode** to take a whole paragraph, or drag it across.
- Add **narration**, **B-roll**, **titles** and **sections**. Drag blocks by ⠿ or use ↑ ↓. New blocks go after the highlighted block.
- Trim a soundbite by typing its **In** and **Out** timecode.
- The panel shows running time in total and per speaker; lines already used are underlined in the transcript.
- **Structure** adds starter sections (three acts, investigation, character profile, explainer). **Remove sections…** takes a structure's sections out again (your other blocks stay), with Undo.

Export Timeline tab

Creates a file your editing software can open: FCPXML for Final Cut and Resolve, XML for Premiere, or an EDL. Soundbites become clips at their source timecode; narration, B-roll and titles become gaps with markers. It's a round trip through files, not a live connection. *Clip paths for* points the clips at someone else's footage folder.

Coloured markers for Resolve: a marker for every line of the edit, spanning its length, coloured by kind (sections red, soundbites blue, narration green, B-roll yellow, titles purple; untick any you don't want). Import the timeline first, then right-click it in the Media Pool › Timelines › Import › Timeline Markers from EDL…

12. A/V Script

Your edit as a two-column Video/Audio script. Type what we see in the Video column; storyboard frames linked to a block appear beside it. Save as **.md**, **.txt** or **PDF** (Courier New, script layout).

13. Storyboarder

- **New storyboard**: video or animation, frame shape (16:9, scope, square, vertical…) and frame rate for animation.

- Each shot is a panel with its drawing and notes: scene, seconds, shot type, camera move, transition, action, dialogue, sound. Drag ⠿ to reorder.
- Click a frame to draw it full size (pen with tablet pressure, marker, eraser, text), with safe-area, rule-of-thirds and shot-size framing guides, a background photo, and a link to a block in your paper edit.
- **Play animatic** plays the shots for their durations with captions and transitions. **Print** makes a storyboard sheet.

14. Shot List

Shot lists for a film or video shoot: one list per shoot day, scene or location.

- **New shot list**: a name, the shoot date and call time, the location and notes for the day (parking, contacts, what must be done by lunch). Lists with a date appear on the Calendar.
- Each shot is a row: scene, size (wide, medium, close-up…), angle, movement, lens, what's in frame and what happens, interior or exterior, time of day, seconds on screen, minutes to shoot, gear, sound and notes. Everything saves as you type. Tick the box on set when you've got it; **Hide done** shows what's left.
- Shots are numbered from their order and scene: 12A, 12B, 13A… (plain 1, 2, 3 when scenes aren't numbered). Drag a row by ⠿ or use ↑ ↓ to reorder; **Sort by scene** puts them in scene order.
- **Storyboard and shot list in one view.** The Frame column shows the storyboard drawing a shot is linked to; click it (or “Link frame”) to pick a frame from any of the project's storyboards, which also fills in the shot's size, movement, scene and seconds where they were empty. The **Board** view shows every shot as a card with its frame, like a storyboard sheet; it prints that way too.
- **Add from a storyboard** turns a storyboard's frames into shots (each keeps a link ▦ back to its frame); **Add scenes from the screenplay** adds one master shot per scene heading, with INT/EXT and day/night filled in.
- The chips above the table add things up: shots done, scenes, screen time and about how long the day will take to shoot. The project details document (Projects page) includes every list.
- **Exports**: **Call sheet** (PDF or Word) puts the day on one page: call and wrap time, location, access and parking, weather and nearest hospital (fill these in under Details), your notes, the crew from the Team page with their contacts, the people from the Interviews page booked for that date, and the schedule, with each shot's start time worked out from the call time and its minutes. **Shot list (PDF)** prints the list with a tick box per shot. **CSV** is every column for a spreadsheet; **CSV for scheduling apps** puts the scene number and shot letter in their own columns with the headings StudioBinder, Shot Lister and similar apps import (their import screens let you match any column that differs). **Calendar (.ics)** adds the shoot day to your calendar, plus a block for each shot that has a time and minutes.

15. Zine Planner

- **New zine** with presets (mini, pocket, half-size, digest) on US Letter or A4 paper (US Letter Half, Quarter, Eighth or A5, A6, A7), portrait or landscape.
- **Sketch**: draw and type on every page, shown as booklet spreads or all at once. Add or remove pages one, two or four at a time; a note says how many blank pages a folded booklet would add when printed if the count isn't a multiple of four.
- **Critique**: upload pages, mock-ups, PDFs or video and comment on them. On images, click a spot to pin a comment.

16. Writing

Tools for articles, nonfiction and fiction. Pick a draft at the top or make one with **+ New draft**: an article or fiction, blank or from a structure (inverted pyramid, feature, explainer, profile, investigation, essay, nonfiction book; three acts, Save the Cat, Hero's Journey, kishōtenketsu, short story). **Claim** tells collaborators you're working on it.

Draft

- **Draft details**: title, byline, contact details (for manuscripts), word target, deadline; for articles, an embargo time and your style guide (AP or Chicago).
- **Write**: the binder (left) lists parts or chapters and their sections or scenes: add, rename, reorder (↑ ↓), delete. The whole draft scrolls as one page; the inspector (right) shows the scene you're in: status, synopsis, and for fiction point of view, setting, story time and plot threads, plus the story-bible names it mentions.
- **Corkboard**: a card per scene with its synopsis; move cards with ← →.
- **Package this** starts a package on the Packaging page from the draft (headline, standfirst, keywords). **Mark as claim** (articles) adds the selected sentence to the fact-check list. **Save version** keeps a snapshot.
- **Export**: standard manuscript format (.docx: Times New Roman 12, double spaced, your contact details and word count on page one, “Surname / TITLE / page” on later pages, # between scenes, chapters on new pages), a document (.docx or PDF), Markdown or plain text. Exports warn while claims aren't verified.

Check

- **Fact-check** (articles): each claim with a status (Unchecked, Verified, Disputed, Cut), linked to a Research note or other evidence. *Find in draft* jumps to it.
- **Quote checker** (articles): every quotation in the draft compared with the transcripts on Media & Transcripts: word for word, close (check the wording, with what the transcript says) or not found, with the speaker and timecode.
- **Style and readability**: reading ease and grade level, long sentences, possible passive voice, adverbs, filler words, clichés, repeated words and your own banned words; AP or Chicago rules

for articles (numbers, months, a.m./p.m., serial commas, dashes); dialogue tags and filter words for fiction. Click any example to find it.

Story

- **Story bible** (or People, places and things for articles): characters, places, things, groups and lore with aliases, a summary and details, and the scenes that mention them. Shared by every draft in the project.
- **Plot threads** (fiction): a grid of threads against scenes; click a square to mark a scene as carrying a thread. Threads that vanish for a long stretch or stop before the end are flagged.
- **Story timeline** (fiction): scenes in story order, from their story time, beside reading order, so flashbacks stand out.

Reporting

- **Sources**: who they are, how they can be quoted (on the record, background, deep background, off the record, anonymous), what was agreed, why anonymity was granted and who approved it, and a log of every contact. *+ from Interviews* adds people from the Interviews page. Link each source to their interview and their transcripts: the quote checker then checks quotes attributed to them (by name in the same sentence) against their own transcripts, and warns if a quote matches someone else's.
- **Records requests**: FOIA, state, UK and Canadian requests with the legal deadline worked out from the date sent (business days skip weekends), status and tracking number. Deadlines show on the Calendar.
- **Event timeline**: what happened when, with sources and whether it's confirmed. Export as PDF, Word or CSV (for Datawrapper or TimelineJS).

Revisions

- **Versions and tracked changes**: compare any two versions, or a version with the draft now; added words are underlined and cut words struck through. Add editor notes to each version, or restore one as a new draft.
- **Feedback** from beta readers and editors, by reader and round, tied to a scene, marked open, addressed or won't do.
- **Revision passes**: a grid of scenes against passes (structure, dialogue, fact-check, proofread… add your own) to tick off.
- **Legal and ethics review** (articles): a pre-publication checklist. It isn't legal advice.
- **Corrections** (articles): what it said, what's right, where it ran, with a correction note to copy.

Business and Goals

- **Business**: pitches, agent queries (with the query letter), magazine and contest submissions: where they went, replies and how long they took, fees, kill fees, rights granted, invoices and payments. **Invoice** makes a numbered invoice as a PDF or .docx; overdue payments are flagged.

- **Goals**: a daily word goal, today's words, your streak and the last 30 days, plus each draft's progress. Words count as you write on this page; cutting text doesn't lower the count.

17. Screenplay

Write scripts in standard Hollywood format: Courier New 12pt, each element at its own margin. Start one with **+ New script**, or **Import Fountain**.

- **Elements**: scene heading, action, character, parenthetical, dialogue, transition and shot. The buttons above the script (or Cmd/Ctrl+1 to 7) set the type of the line you're on.
- **Enter** starts the next element: after a scene heading comes action, after a character name comes dialogue, after dialogue comes action. **Shift+Enter** adds a line break inside an element. **Tab** changes the type, or finishes a character name or location it suggests. Typing `(` in empty dialogue starts a parenthetical. Backspace at the start of an element joins it to the one above.
- In action, a line starting INT. or EXT. becomes a scene heading, a short line in capitals becomes a character, and a line ending in TO: becomes a transition when you press Enter.
- Beside the script: every scene (click to jump) and every character with their number of speeches. The page count at the top is also the rough running time (a page a minute).
- **Pages** shows the script laid out exactly as it prints: 54 lines a page, page numbers from page 2, (MORE) and (CONT'D) when a speech crosses a page, and scene headings and names never stranded at the bottom of a page. Tick **Scene numbers** for a shooting script, and **Title page** to include one (fill it in under Title page and details).
- **Export**: PDF, Final Draft (.fdx) or Fountain (.fountain, which opens in Highland, WriterSolo, Fade In, Arc Studio and others).
- **Dual dialogue**: two characters speaking at once. Click into the second character's name and click **Dual dialogue**: their speech sits beside the one before it on the page (and in Final Draft and Fountain files).
- **Revisions**: once a script is out, click **Start Blue revision**. Everything you change from then on is marked with * in the margin; pages with changes carry “Blue Revision” and the date at the top, and the title page lists each revision. The next revision is Pink, then Yellow, Green, Goldenrod, Buff, Salmon, Cherry (the industry's order). **Colour the revised pages** tints them like the coloured paper used on set; **Clear marks** removes the marks when you issue a clean draft.
- **Breakdown** (third view): every scene with its length in eighths of a page, who speaks (cast), and what you've tagged: props, wardrobe, makeup and hair, extras, vehicles, stunts, special effects, sound, music, animals, set dressing, notes. Select words in the script and use **Tag selection as…**, type them in, or click a suggestion (words in CAPITALS in the action, as screenwriters write new props and sounds). Order the scenes by location or time of day to plan shoot days. Export **breakdown sheets** (PDF, one per scene), a **CSV**, or the **shooting order** (PDF).
- **Make a storyboard** (Export menu) makes a Storyboarder board with a shot per scene, with the action and dialogue filled in. **Make an A/V script** makes a paper edit (a section per scene, action as B-roll, dialogue as narration) that the A/V Script page shows as a two-column script.

18. Music

Songs (the song sketchbook)

Each song has a status, key, tempo, time signature and length, and four parts:

Sheet music. Pick **Note** or **Rest**, a length (whole, half, quarter, eighth, sixteenth, with a dot for half as long again) and, for notes, a sharp, flat or natural, then **click on the staff** where the note goes: it lands at the pitch under the pointer, after the note to the left of the click (or at the end of the line). Click a note head to select it, or use the **Select** tool, which picks the nearest note even if you miss a little. With a note selected: ↑ **Step** and ↓ **Step** move it, **Octave** ↑ and **Octave** ↓ move it an octave, a length or ♯ ♭ ♮ button changes it, **Delete** removes it, and ← → pick the note before or after. On the keyboard (click the score first): the arrow keys, Shift+↑/↓ for an octave, Delete or Backspace, and Esc. The **Erase** tool deletes whatever note you click. **New line** adds an empty line of music at the end (or, with a note selected, starts a new line after it; Enter does the same), and **Bar line** adds a bar line. Underneath, the same music is shown as ABC notation and can be typed or pasted; the two always match.

Playing notes in from a MIDI keyboard. Plug in a MIDI keyboard or controller (USB, or Bluetooth paired with your computer), open Sheet music and press **Connect MIDI keyboard**; the browser asks to allow MIDI the first time. Each key you press goes in at the length picked above, after the selected note (or at the end of the music), and you hear it as it goes in; **Sound** turns that off. Keys pressed together go in as a chord. Notes are spelled for the key (in D major, F♯ is written as F, the key signature sharpens it), a bar line goes in when a bar fills up, and a new line starts every four bars. Change the length between notes with the length buttons. Works in Chrome, Edge and Firefox; Safari can't use MIDI keyboards.

- **Lyrics and chords**: write chords in square brackets where they change, `[G]Walking down the [C]road`, and sections on their own line, `[Chorus]`. The preview shows chords above the words and syllables per line. ♭ **Down** and ♯ **Up** transpose by a semitone.
- **Sheet music**, written in ABC notation (letters for notes, numbers for lengths, | for bar lines, a `w:` line for lyrics under the notes); the buttons insert notes and symbols, and the notation is drawn as you type. The note buttons follow the song's key: in D ♭ major they read D ♭ E ♭ F G ♭ A ♭ B ♭ C (the key signature makes them sharp or flat), with the key note highlighted; use = for a natural. **Play** plays it back (the instrument sounds load from the internet).
- **Split sheet**: each writer's role, share, PRO, IPI number, publisher and whether they've signed. The shares must add up to 100% (*Split equally* helps); + *from the Team page* adds your team.
- **Sessions and versions**: log each session (who, what got recorded, notes), and each version (demo, mix v1…) with an audio file or a link and notes pinned to times in the track: play, pause where something's wrong, type a note and press Enter. Click a note's time to jump there.

Export (next to the song title) opens a menu. As PDFs: sheet music and lyrics together, either one alone, or the split sheet with signature lines. As files: **MIDI** (.mid, for GarageBand, Logic, MuseScore and the like), the sheet music as ABC text (.abc) or as an image (.svg), and the lyrics with chords as text (.txt). **Export PDF** and **Export MIDI** also sit under the score.

Gigs and bookings

Each show from enquiry to paid: venue, contact, deal and fee, load-in, soundcheck and set times, a setlist from your songs (with its total length), notes and payment. **Copy advance email** writes the email confirming the details with the venue; **Print setlist** prints it big for the stage. Gigs show on the Calendar.

Releases

Package the video (on a release) starts a YouTube package for the music video and a Shorts/Reels one for teasers, sharing their keywords. Set a release date and the plan works back from it: masters, artwork, PRO registration and ISRCs, sample clearance, signed splits, distributor upload, editorial pitch, pre-save, press, video, social posts, release day and follow-up. Tick steps off; add or remove your own. Tracks get their ISRC codes here, and uncleared samples or unsigned split sheets are flagged. Every step shows on the Calendar.

Sample clearances

Every sample: the original, what you used, whether it needs the recording owner, the song owner or both, who you're talking to, status (not started → cleared, denied or replaced), fee, terms and where the agreement is filed.

19. Data Analysis

Load a **CSV** or an **Excel file** (.xlsx). For a workbook with several sheets you pick the sheet, and a **Sheet** drop-down in the dataset bar switches to another sheet later (the workbook is kept). Numbers, dates and TRUE/FALSE come through as they would from "Save as CSV", and formulas by their last calculated value. The R code loads the file with `readxl::read_excel()` and the same sheet.

The **Rows** section shows the filtered rows a page at a time: pick the page number and how many rows per page. The **Chart** controls name the axes: for a scatter chart choose the x axis and y axis variables (and a variable to colour by); for bars, the groups and the height (number of rows, or the sum, average or median of a variable); for a line, what runs along x and what is measured. ⇄ **Swap axes** exchanges them, or turns a bar chart sideways. The R code follows whatever you choose.

- **Load a CSV** to see a profile of each column (type, missing values, statistics).
- **Filter** rows and draw a quick chart: histogram, bar, scatter or line. Hover for values, or show the numbers as a table.
- The page writes matching **R code** (tidyverse) to copy or save as .R and run in RStudio. *Make it with* chooses **ggplot2** (draws the chart in R) or **Datawrapper** (sends the chart to your Datawrapper account through its API; you'll need an API token, explained in the code's comments). The code is written on the page, so this works offline.

20. Resources

A table of default resources, plus your own: add them one at a time or upload a CSV (name, description, link). Export your table as a CSV.

> To change the default table for everyone (on GitHub Pages): make the spreadsheet with the columns Name, Description, Link (Title, URL or Notes also work) and save it as CSV named `default-resources-cobbler-project.csv`. On GitHub, open the repository, *Add file › Upload files*, drop it in, and *Commit changes*. It replaces the old one, and the site shows it within a few minutes. Links can be a plain address or `[Link text](https://…)`.

21. Comments

The speech-bubble button opens comments for the page you're on. Select text on the page first to quote it. Reply, edit, resolve or delete comments; *All pages in project* lists every page's comments. Comments belong to the active project.

Assign a comment to someone on the Team (when writing it, or with *Assign to…* on any comment): it then shows with their tasks on the Team page.

22. Settings and themes

- **Themes**: Light, Dark, Rainbow (every surface an accent colour) or System Default (follows your computer's light/dark setting).
- **Storage**: how much room the app's projects and files take in this browser (the browser decides the limit, usually gigabytes), which projects and parts use the most, and how much room uploaded files take. **Trim old history** removes activity older than 90 days; **Keep my files safe** asks the browser not to clear uploaded files when your disk is low. A note appears on any page when storage is 80% full.
  - Big projects are saved **compressed**, usually 3 to 5 times smaller (transcripts and notes compress well). Storage shows how much it saves.
  - **Housekeeping**: which projects still keep transcripts inside them (move them on Media & Transcripts); **Back up and remove** for archived projects (downloads a copy with its files, then frees the space: import it to bring it back); and **Find unused files**, which deletes uploads and transcripts no project uses any more, after asking.
- **Downloads**: this guide, the guide to editing the code, and the whole app as a ZIP (code only: your projects aren't included; back them up from the Projects page).
- **Tutorial**: starts (or continues) the guided tour of every page.
- **Backups**: your projects live only in this browser, so keep a copy elsewhere. **Back up automatically to a folder…** (Chrome and Edge) asks you to choose a folder, ideally a synced one such as Google Drive, Dropbox or iCloud Drive, and from then on writes a backup of every project into “Cobbler backups” inside it every day or week, keeping the newest few (you choose

how often and how many). The first backup is written straight away. Without automatic backups, a note reminds you once a day when there's work that hasn't been backed up for a week, with “Back up now” (the download) and a link to set backups up. Any backup file restores through Projects › Import.

- **This browser**: what this browser can and can't do (database, offline use, folder sync and automatic backups, Excel files, other tabs, keeping data when the disk is low). The app also asks the browser, once there's real work in it, to keep this site's data when the disk runs low; Storage shows whether it agreed.
- **Self-tests**: a page that checks merging, syncing, undo, transcripts, screenplay pages and more on made-up data, in a few milliseconds. Your projects aren't touched.

23. Where your work is saved

> Your work stays in this browser, on this computer, and in a sync folder if you choose one. Nothing is uploaded to the website, even when the app itself is online. Back up regularly from the Projects page.

- Projects are saved in the browser's database (IndexedDB), which has room for far more than a few megabytes. Very long transcripts or many drawings still take the most room, and the browser may ask before letting a site use a lot.
- Uploaded files (critique files, storyboard photos, datasets) and transcripts moved to file storage are kept separately in the browser's file storage. **They aren't part of project backups** (Export), but they are part of shared files (Share): keep your originals, or keep transcripts in a folder.
- Another browser, or another computer, has its own separate copy. Use Backup and Restore, Share, or a sync folder to move projects.
- The app at a different address (say on GitHub Pages instead of your computer) also has its own separate copy: back up all projects at the old address and import them at the new one.
- Clearing your browser's site data deletes your projects, so back up first. Better: turn on automatic backups to a folder in Settings › Backups, so a copy is always somewhere else.

24. Keyboard shortcuts

Where	Keys	What
Drawing (zines, storyboards)	P · M · E · T	Pen · Marker · Eraser · Text
Anywhere	Ctrl/Cmd+Z · Ctrl/Cmd+Shift+Z (or Ctrl+Y)	Undo · Redo your last change (in a text box: your typing)
Drawing	Ctrl/Cmd+Z · Ctrl/Cmd+Shift+Z	Undo · Redo strokes

Screenplay	Enter · Shift+Enter · Tab · Cmd/Ctrl+1–7	Next element · new line · change type or finish a name · set the type
Storyboard frame	[·]	Previous · next shot
Animatic player	Space · ← →	Play/pause · previous/next shot
Comments, lists	Ctrl/Cmd+Enter	Send a comment or reply
Goal and checklist lists	Enter · Backspace on an empty line	New line · remove line
Anywhere	Esc	Close a window, panel or the sidebar (on small screens)